like respiration, digestion and excretion. The bulk flow of fluids can transport substances to long distances faster than by diffusion. The human circulatory system can circulate a millilitre of blood from the heart to feet and back again within 60 sec, rather than 60 years which may be needed if it were by diffusion.

Within our body, the oxygen and carbon dioxide are exchanged in the lungs and tissues whereas nutrients from the digestive system are carried to the liver and the wastes from the tissues are carried by the blood and finally removed by the kidneys. The hormones are transported to their target organs. Circulatory system helps to maintain the homeostasis of the body fluids and body temperature (heat exchange).

The homeostatic regulation of the cardio-vascular system maintains blood flow, or perfusion, to the heart and brain. In vasovagal syncope (fainting), signals from the nervous system cause a sudden decrease in blood pressure, and the individual faints from lack of oxygen to the brain.

In this chapter you will learn how the heart and blood vessels work together most of the time to prevent such problems.

7.1 Body Fluids

The body fluid consists of water and substances dissolved in them. There are two types of body fluids, the intracellular fluid present inside the cells and the extracellular fluid present outside the cells. The three types of extracellular fluids are the **interstitial fluid** or tissue fluid (surrounding the cell), the **plasma** (fluid component of the blood) and **lymph.** The blood flowing into the capillary from an arteriole has a high hydrostatic pressure. This pressure is brought about by the pumping action of the blood and it tends to force water and small molecules out through the permeable walls of the capillary into the tissue fluid.

The volume of fluid which leaves the capillary to form tissue fluid is the result of two pressures (hydrostatic pressure and colloidal osmotic pressure). At the anterior end of the capillary bed, the water potential is lesser than hydrostatic pressure inside the capillary bed which is enough to push fluid into the tissues. The tissue fluid has low concentration of protein than that of plasma. At the venous end of the capillary bed, the water potential is greater than the hydrostatic pressure and the fluid from the tissues flows into the capillary and water is drawn back into the blood, taking with it waste products produced by the cells.

Composition of Blood

Blood is the most common body fluid that transports substances from one part of the body to the other. Blood is a connective tissue consisting of plasma (fluid matrix) and formed elements. The plasma constitutes 55% of the total blood volume. The remaining 45% is the formed elements that consist of blood cells. The average blood volume is about 5000ml (5L) in an adult weighing 70 Kg.

7.1.1 Plasma

Plasma mainly consists of water (80-92%) in which the plasma proteins, inorganic constituents (0.9%), organic constituents (0.1%) and respiratory gases are dissolved. The four main types of plasma proteins synthesized in the liver are albumin, globulin, prothrombin and fibrinogen. **Albumin** maintains the osmotic pressure of the blood. **Globulin** facilitates the transport

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